

## 첫소리 ㅅ·ㅆ·ㅎ: 사다? 싸다? 하다?

Learn three Korean first sounds that English speakers often mix up: soft ㅅ, tense ㅆ and ㅎ (h), with word pairs like 사다/싸다 and 살/쌀.

### WHAT THIS IS FOR



Tell apart and pronounce word-initial ㅅ, ㅆ and ㅎ, and choose the right word in pairs such as 사다/싸다 and 살/쌀.

## 1 THE LETTERS

| LETTER | SOUND                                                                                                                                                                | TRACE AND COPY          |
|--------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| ㅅ      | A soft s with a little breath after it, like the s in 'sun' said gently. Before ㅣ it sounds close to 'sh' (시 ≈ 'shee').<br>사과 (sagwa), 살 (sal), 시간 (sigan)           | <div></div> <div></div> |
| ㅆ      | A tight, strong s with no puff of breath after it. Tense your throat and say 's' sharply. Before ㅣ it sounds like a tight 'sh' (씨).<br>싸다 (ssada), 쌀 (ssal), 씨 (ssi) | <div></div> <div></div> |
| ㅎ      | Like the h in 'hat'.<br>하나 (hana), 학교 (hakgyo), 하다 (hada)                                                                                                            | <div></div> <div></div> |

## 2 NOW THE WORDS

| WORD        | MEANING                     | IN USE                                                |
|-------------|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| 사과<br>sagwa | apple                       | 사과 하나 주세요.<br>One apple, please.                      |
| 사다<br>sada  | to buy                      | 편의점에서 물을 사요.<br>I buy water at the convenience store. |
| 싸다<br>ssada | to be cheap                 | 이 옷은 정말 싸요.<br>These clothes are really cheap.        |
| 살<br>sal    | years old (counter for age) | 저는 스무 살이에요.<br>I'm twenty years old.                  |
| 쌀<br>ssal   | rice (uncooked grain)       | 마트에서 쌀을 샀어요.<br>I bought rice at the supermarket.     |





| WORD               | MEANING                                     | IN USE                                                                 |
|--------------------|---------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 하나<br><i>hana</i>  | one (when counting)                         | 하나, 둘, 셋!<br>One, two, three!                                          |
| 시간<br><i>sigan</i> | time; hour                                  | 오늘 시간 있어요?<br>Are you free today? (literally: Do you have time today?) |
| 씨<br><i>ssi</i>    | Mr./Ms. (polite title after someone's name) | 민수 씨, 안녕하세요?<br>Hello, Minsu.                                          |
| 하다<br><i>hada</i>  | to do                                       | 주말에 뭐 해요?<br>What do you do on weekends?                               |

### 3 YOUR TURN

#### CHOOSE THE RIGHT SOUND



Say each option out loud, listen for a soft breathy s (ㅅ), a tight s (ㅆ) or an h (ㅎ), then choose or write the one that fits.

- Fill in the blank with 사요 or 싸요: 이 사과는 아주 \_\_\_\_.
- Fill in the blank with 사요 or 싸요: 저는 시장에서 사과를 \_\_\_\_.
- Fill in the blank with 사요 or 해요: 저는 학교에서 공부를 \_\_\_\_.
- Fill in the blank with 살 or 쌀: 저는 열 \_\_\_\_이에요.
- Write the first consonant (ㅅ, ㅆ or ㅎ) of each word: 하나 / 씨 / 시간

### ✓ ANSWERS

- |       |              |
|-------|--------------|
| 1) 싸요 | 4) 살         |
| 2) 사요 | 5) ㅎ / ㅆ / ㅅ |
| 3) 해요 |              |

